I walked in, watched him writing for what seemed an inordinately long time. The poor chap who went before me, I thought, must have had a lot going on.

Still not looking up, the doctor ordered me to step behind the curtain, take off my clothes, he'd be with me in a moment.

I went behind, stripped, hopped onto the examination table. Five minutes passed.

At last the curtain pulled back and there was the doctor.

He looked at me, blinked once, and said: *Oh. I see. It's you.*

Yes. I thought you'd been warned, but I get the sense you hadn't.

Right. So, you're here. Riiight. OK. It's you. Hm. Remind me of the problem?

I showed him my todger, softened by Elizabeth Arden.

He couldn't see anything.

Nothing to see, I explained. It was an invisible scourge. For whatever reason, my particular case of frostnip manifested as greatly heightened *sensation*…

How did this happen? he wanted to know.

North Pole, I told him. I went to the North Pole and now my South Pole is on the fritz.

His face said: Curiouser and curiouser.

I described the cascading dysfunctions. *Everything's difficult, Doctor. Sitting. Walking.* Sex, I added, was out of the question. Worse, my todger constantly felt like it was *having* sex. Or ready to. I was sort of losing it, I told him. I'd made the mistake of googling this injury, and I'd read horror stories about *partial penectomies*, a phrase you never want to come across when googling your symptoms.

The doctor assured me it was unlikely I'd need one of those.

Unlikely?

He said he was going to try to rule out other things. He gave me a full examination, which was more than invasive. No stone unturned, so to speak.

The likeliest cure, he announced at last, would be time.